06 | CLEAR REQUESTS | RESOURCE

Clear Requests: Escalating the Right Way

Hand off the decision. Keep doing your part.

01	**Name the exact decision** Get specific. “Which coverage option is approved?” works better than “Can you deal with this?” Say whether you need an answer, an approval, or a clarification.
02	**Check authority and boundaries** Look at the current role guidance, your branch RACI, and the Decision & Permission Matrix. Sort out what’s yours and what belongs to someone else.
03	**Gather facts and required input** Use current sources and confirmed facts. Point out what’s missing. Get the input you need, and don’t pass off a guess as a fact.
04	**Offer options and a recommendation** Offer two workable options when you can. Show what each means for services, resources, and trade-offs. If only one works, say why.
05	**Check who decides and the deadline** Confirm who decides, when the decision is needed, when you’ll hear back, and when the next update is due. A date you asked for isn’t a date someone agreed to.
06	**Follow up and share the outcome** Before you send, decide who will follow up. After you hear back, write down the answer, confirm the next step and who owns it, and update the people affected.

An answer isn’t always a fix

Within two working days you’ll get an answer or the name of the person handling your question. That doesn’t mean the issue will be solved by then. If it needs more time, confirm when the next update is coming. Urgent issues go through the required process right away.

Based on: Decision & Escalation training, six-step request checklist; Communicating CLEAR training, slide 41.

06 | CLEAR REQUESTS | RESOURCE (CONTINUED)

Clear Requests: Worksheet and Examples

Use real facts, approved sources, and confirmed dates.

Step	Your request
What I need decided	
Authority and source	
Facts and input	
Options and my pick	
Who decides, and when	
Follow-up and next step	

Sample request

Coverage decision

"We need a decision between two coverage options. The attached summary lays out the gap, both options, and the input we got. I recommend option A because it keeps the service window covered. We need an answer before the window opens. Can you tell me who will decide and when we'll hear back? I'll watch for the reply and update the team."

Example only.

Following up

"Following up on my request from _____. We'd agreed on an update by _____. Still open: _____. What's new: _____. If this waits, _____. Can you send the answer, who's handling it, or when the next update will be?"

Once you have an answer

Write down the decision and any limits. Confirm who does what and by when. Let the affected people know. Until it's approved, stick to the work you already have authority to do.

Based on: Decision & Escalation training, six-step request checklist; Communicating CLEAR training, slide 41.